title: "Mental Health & Wellbeing Policy (Staff & Residents)" version: "1.0" effectiveDate: "[Insert Date]" reviewDate: "[Insert Date – usually annually]" appliesTo: "All staff, residents, volunteers, and visitors at [INSERT CARE HOME NAME]"

Mental Health & Wellbeing Policy (Staff & Residents)

Policy Title: Mental Health & Wellbeing (Staff & Residents)
Effective Date: [Insert Date]
Review Date: [Insert Date – usually annually]
Version: 1.0
Applies to: All staff, residents, volunteers, and visitors at [INSERT CARE HOME NAME]

1. Policy Statement

At [INSERT CARE HOME NAME], we recognise that mental health and wellbeing are as important as physical health. We are committed to creating an environment that promotes positive mental wellbeing, provides support for those experiencing mental health difficulties, and reduces stigma and discrimination.

We aim to:

- Support residents' emotional and psychological wellbeing through personalised, compassionate care.
- Protect and promote staff wellbeing by fostering a safe, supportive, and inclusive workplace.
- Ensure compliance with the Health and Social Care Act 2008 (Regulated Activities) Regulations 2014, CQC Fundamental Standards, and Equality Act 2010.
- Encourage openness, respect, and proactive support for mental health.

2. Purpose

This policy outlines how [INSERT CARE HOME NAME]:

- Promotes positive mental health and wellbeing.
- Provides early intervention and support when mental health concerns arise.
- Ensures staff and residents can access appropriate professional services.
- Embeds wellbeing into the care home's culture and daily practice.

3. Scope

This policy applies to:

- All residents, including those with diagnosed mental health conditions or cognitive impairments.
- All employees, agency staff, and volunteers.
- Family members and visitors, where wellbeing support relates to care delivery and safeguarding.

4. Roles and Responsibilities

Registered Manager:

- Leads on the promotion of mental health and wellbeing initiatives.
- Ensures appropriate resources and training are available.
- Provides access to external mental health professionals when required.

Supervisors / Team Leaders:

- Support staff wellbeing through supervision, appraisal, and open communication.
- Monitor residents' emotional wellbeing as part of holistic care planning.
- Escalate concerns to senior management or external services.

All Staff:

- Treat residents, colleagues, and visitors with empathy, respect, and dignity.
- Encourage open conversations around mental health and wellbeing.
- Report concerns promptly to management.

5. Promoting Resident Mental Health & Wellbeing

- Person-Centred Care – individual care plans consider emotional, social, and psychological needs.
- Activities & Engagement – meaningful activities offered to promote self-esteem, reduce isolation, and encourage social interaction.
- Environment – safe, calm, and supportive surroundings that enhance wellbeing.
- Access to Services – referrals made to GPs, community mental health teams, counselling, or psychological therapies as required.
- Safeguarding – protection from abuse, neglect, and poor care practices that may impact mental health.

6. Supporting Staff Mental Health & Wellbeing

- Workplace Culture – promote openness, inclusion, and respect.
- Supervision & Appraisal – provide opportunities to discuss workload, stress, and wellbeing.
- Training – all staff receive training on mental health awareness, stress management, and resilience.
- Employee Assistance – access to occupational health or wellbeing services where available.
- Work-Life Balance – encourage flexible working and fair rotas to reduce stress and burnout.
- Zero Tolerance – for bullying, harassment, and discrimination.

7. Crisis and Incident Response

- Residents – any signs of distress, suicidal thoughts, or acute mental health episodes will be treated as urgent and referred to appropriate professionals.
- Staff – immediate support will be provided, with referral to occupational health, GP, or counselling services if necessary.

- Post-Incident Support – debriefs and reflective practice sessions provided following serious incidents.

8. Monitoring and Review

- Resident care plans reviewed regularly to assess emotional and psychological wellbeing.
- Staff wellbeing monitored through supervision, absence management, and staff surveys.
- Feedback from residents, families, and staff considered in quality assurance processes.
- Policy reviewed annually or sooner following significant incidents or updated guidance.

9. References

- Health and Social Care Act 2008 (Regulated Activities) Regulations 2014
- CQC Fundamental Standards – Regulation 9 (Person-Centred Care) & Regulation 18 (Staffing)
- NICE Guidelines on Mental Wellbeing and Mental Health in Adults
- Equality Act 2010
- Mindful Employer Charter & NHS Staff Wellbeing Resources

10. Related Policies

- Safeguarding Adults Policy
- Equality, Diversity & Inclusion Policy
- Training & Development / Supervision Policy
- Appraisal Policy
- Staff Health & Wellbeing Policy
- Complaints and Compliments Policy

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